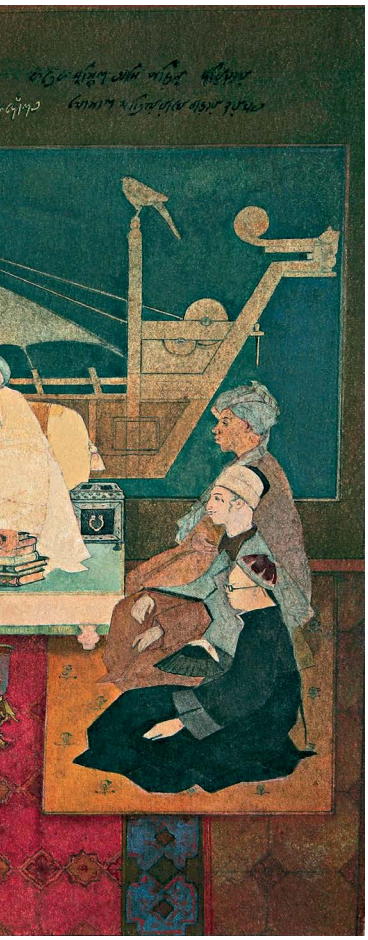


Nights, Cubist Expression, and Feminine Interiors of Jorasanko, an exhibition of works by the trio of artist-siblings Gaganendranath Tagore (1867-1938), Abanindranath Tagore (1871-1951) and Sunayani Devi.

But Bengal already lives and breathes Tagore, and Santiniketan even more so. Did it really need a biennale to bring attention to their art? Sivakumar ends with a small example. "Ask any educated Indian layman where the 'Mona Lisa' is and they will answer at the drop of a hat. But ask them where the 'Bharat Mata' is, and they will fumble," he says. Drawn by Abanindranath Tagore, the painting is quite literally the picture of Indian nationalism. Perhaps viewers will have a better idea after a visit to the Victoria Memorial Hall during the biennale. ■

–Malini Banerjee

FORT FESTIVAL

*The upcoming **Jaigarh Heritage Festival** promises to be a celebration of all things Jaipur*

The debut edition of the festival will be held at the spectacular **JAIGARH FORT** in Jaipur from Dec. 27 to 29

The debut edition of the Jaigarh Heritage Festival will be held at the spectacular Jaigarh Fort in Jaipur from December 27 to 29. Curated by Teamwork Arts in collaboration with Maharaja Sawai Padmanabh Singh, the festival aims to celebrate Jaipur's rich traditions while contributing to the city's development as a premier tourist destination.

"The Jaigarh Heritage Festival celebrates Jaigarh's historical significance as one of Rajasthan's oldest medieval bastions and my family's enduring commitment to the arts, culture and heritage of Jaipur and the Dhundhar region," says Singh. "Through a diverse array of offerings—from mesmerising performances to immersive heritage trails and dynamic craft experiences—we aim to pay homage to the city's myriad tangible and intangible histories," adds Sanjoy Roy, managing director, Teamwork Arts.

The invite-only opening night will showcase an exclusive performance, setting the tone for an exceptional series of events. Mornings will commence with soulful performances on the fort terraces, featuring performers such as Sandeep Singh, a pioneer in the revival of the bowed string instruments *taus* and *dilruba*. Throughout the day, audiences will witness performances by Rajasthan's finest folk and classical artistes, such as Shyopat Julia, Nathulal Solanki, Kalbelia dancers and folk poets. Each evening, delegates and audiences will experience 'Jaigarh at Dusk', a captivating blend of folk and classical performances. These evenings will feature acclaimed artistes, such as 'Folk Queen of India' Malini Awasthi, renowned choreographer and classical dancer Rukmini Vijayakumar, percussion ensemble Tal Fry and more. "Jaipur, with its rich cultural heritage and deep respect for artistic traditions, is the perfect setting for artistes to come together and be part of a magical festival," says Awasthi.

The Craft Courtyard will feature Jaipur's artisans, inviting audiences to engage with local crafts such as blue pottery and appliqué embroidery. "The heritage trails will introduce delegates to the storied pasts of Jaigarh Fort, perched atop Cheel Ka Teela in the Aravalli range, showcasing Jaipur's military brilliance and architectural grandeur," says Roy. In the evenings, the Jaigarh Night Walk will guide delegates through hidden passages, uncovering the fort's history.

Further, the festival will host conversations on art, architecture, Jaipur's cityscapes, heritage and India's myriad histories, featuring acclaimed speakers, writers and historians. There will also be a curated culinary experience that blends Rajasthani delicacies with rich flavours from across India, alongside an array of global cuisines. ■

–Neha Kirpal



▲ **RESTORING ROOTS** An illuminated Jaigarh Fort; right, Malini Awasthi